searching for Soviet submarines. On November 6, about 6:00 p.m., an American submarine surfaced a mile away from the *Divnogorsk* and followed it for some ten minutes.

Despite numerous overflights, no one asked the captains of either the *Divnogorsk* or the *Aleksandrovsk* to show their cargo until the evening of November 9. After 7:00 p.m., the American destroyer *Blandy* (DD 943) approached the *Aleksandrovsk* and demanded by megaphone that the tween decks be opened. The demand was ignored. After a forty-five-minute pursuit of the *Aleksandrovsk*, the *Blandy* approached the *Divnogorsk* and asked, first in English and then in Russian, that the crew show the cargo on the decks and open the tween decks. "According to the agreement of your government and ours, please open the missiles and holds," went the message. "We are going to make a film." Those on board the *Divnogorsk* noticed photographers and camera operators on the deck of the *Blandy*. Major Protasov insisted that the soldiers, who were half-naked because of the heat, be sent to the tween decks, and that only officers remain on the main deck. The military commanders were not happy with that demand but followed KGB orders.[24]

The captain of the *Divnogorsk*, Myroshnichenko, knew nothing about the intergovernmental agreements and refused to communicate with the American vessel. Instead he radioed the minister of the Soviet Merchant Fleet, Viktor Bakaev, and the head of the Black Sea–Azov steamship company, Oleksii Danchenko, for instructions. Radio-telegrams from Odesa and Moscow soon arrived, instructing the captain to reveal the missiles. He was to show the cargo on deck but not to open the tween decks or allow anyone to board the ship. The *Aleksandrovsk*'s cargo, referred to in a KGB report as "particularly important cargo," had to remain secret, as far as the Soviet leadership was concerned. The *Divnogorsk* fared differently. Almost immediately after receiving messages from his superiors in Moscow and Odesa, Captain Myroshnichenko got a radio message from the *Blandy*: you just received instructions, show us the missiles. The Americans had intercepted the *Divnogorsk*'s communication with the ministry.

Captain Myroshnichenko was finally ready to accommodate the American request, but his authority was insufficient—he needed the cooperation of the military commanders on board. The commanding officer